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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the paralegal position in Lipson Lloyd-Jones's Tax Disputes team because contentious tax work sits at the intersection of procedural rigour and substantive legal analysis in a way that maps directly onto what I have been doing at BCLP and Citizens Advice.

At BCLP I spent six months supporting a complex investment arbitration. I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, amended sections of the Claimant's memorial and drafted procedural histories and procedural orders. Shortly before a significant deadline I became the only junior supporting the team, which meant coordinating documents, tracking outstanding actions and helping ensure on-time submission. That experience taught me how to manage competing demands on a live matter without letting things slip, and a partner and associate told me my performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor. The procedural discipline and file management involved in that work is directly relevant to managing contentious tax matters, where missing a deadline or misreading a procedural requirement can be costly.

At Citizens Advice I work across a wide range of matters, but the skill I use most consistently is statutory analysis. Assessing Universal Credit and Housing Benefit eligibility requires reading legislation carefully, identifying exactly what the criteria require and explaining the gap between what a client can evidence and what the rules demand. Tax disputes work calls for the same approach applied to more complex statutory frameworks, and my LLM dissertation on GDPR across jurisdictions gave me practice in close comparative reading of legislation and regulatory instruments.

My interest in contentious work developed from the arbitration seat at BCLP rather than from a long-standing preference for tax specifically. What the arbitration work made clear was that I find procedural disputes genuinely engaging, that I am comfortable working under real deadline pressure, and that I want to develop in a practice area where the technical standard is high. Tax litigation at a specialist firm like Lipson Lloyd-Jones is a logical next step from that, and the firm's focus on disputes rather than advisory tax work means the procedural experience I bring is more directly applicable than it would be in a general practice context.

I am available immediately and would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva